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Jyothi Surekha Vennam might have won nine medals at the World Championships, but she admits the silver she won partnering Rishabh Yadav in the compound mixed team event at the 2025 Worlds in Gwangju, South Korea, is special.

“It’s the first World Championship medal that I’ve won now that compound archery will be a part of the Los Angeles Olympics,” Jyothi tells *Sportstar*.

Indeed, a couple of months before the start of the World Championships, the International Olympic Committee (IOC) announced that compound archery would debut at the 2028 Olympics with the addition of a mixed team event. This made the World Championships particularly significant for Jyothi.

“The fact that we won a silver medal means that we are competing with the best in the world. And now it means that we have a chance at the Olympics too. This silver medal at the World Championships is just one of the steps towards the final target, which is an Olympic medal,” she said.

It might be just the first step, but it’s an important one.

Jyothi’s medals aren’t the only ones won by Indian athletes at World Championships in events that will feature at the 2028 Olympics. At the conclusion of the international season for 2025 — the first year of the 2028 Olympic cycle — India won 12 medals in events that will feature in the Los Angeles edition. Of them, eight have come in shooting and one each in archery, boxing, badminton and wrestling.

This is an improvement on the seven World Championship medals won in 2022 — the first year of the Paris Olympic cycle — and the five World Championship medals won in 2017, the first year of the Tokyo Olympic cycle.

This isn’t to say that there were no other medals won by Indian athletes at World Championships in Olympic sports. However, these came in categories that will not feature at the 2028 Games. Minakshi Hooda (48kg gold), Pooja Rani (80kg bronze) and Nupur Sheoran (80+kg silver), for example, won medals in non-Olympic weight classes at the Boxing World Championships, while Mirabai Chanu